BUNTII

Trust your auntie.

THE COMPANY BEDROCK

Why we exist, who we serve, why we win

The deals on your street, before they're gone. Independent shops first.

North London is the wedge, not the ceiling.

buntii.co.uk · @buntii.app

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What's in here

Every claim in this document is backed by a source. Market and competitor figures are drawn from IGD, Kantar, WRAP, the House of Commons Library, The Grocer, and a 2025 FCA-approved EIS promotion for Gander. Where a number is a company or PR self-report, it is flagged as such. Where independent-sector data does not exist, that gap is named, not hidden.

1 · What Buntii is, in one breath

> Buntii is a hyperlocal app that shows you, in real time, exactly which fresh items are reduced right now at the independent grocers, fishmongers, butchers and bakeries on your street. These are the shops every other deals app is structurally locked out of.

Too Good To Go sells you a *mystery bag*. Gander shows you *supermarket* yellow stickers it pulls from a till. Olio gives away surplus for free. **None of them can show you the £3 tray of strawberries the Turkish greengrocer just marked to 90p**, because that shop has no till to plug into. Buntii does. That is the whole company in one sentence.

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2 · The Why, our reason to exist

WHY-STATEMENT

> **We exist so that good food doesn't die in the bin, and good shops don't die on the high street.**
>
> Every evening, independent traders throw away fresh food they couldn't sell, while families a street away pay full price somewhere else. Buntii closes that gap, one reduced tray and one walkable street at a time.

The three truths underneath it

1. **Waste is a moral and commercial scandal.** UK retail bins around 270,000 tonnes of food a year (WRAP). The edible portion of total UK food waste is worth around £17bn a year. Independents handle surplus crudely, by end-of-day guesswork, haggling, or the bin, because they have no tool to summon demand.
2. **The cost-of-living crisis made deal-hunting normal.** UK food prices rose around 38% between November 2020 and November 2025 (House of Commons Library). Yellow-sticker hunting is no longer stigmatised; it is mainstream, middle-class behaviour. The demand is already there. It just has no map.
3. **The independent high street is being squeezed out.** Fishmongers fell from around 10,000 in the 1950s to under 1,000 today. These shops have no marketing budget, no loyalty scheme, and no way to tell the neighbourhood they have 20 trays to clear at 5pm. Buntii is that megaphone.

> **The line that holds it all together**
>
> *Buntii turns one shop's loss into one family's saving, and makes the independent trader, not the supermarket, the hero of the story.*

3 · The problem we serve

Buntii is a two-sided marketplace. It only works if it solves a real, sharp pain on both sides at once. Here is exactly who hurts, and how.

The trader's pain, the supply side

Primary ICP: independent Turkish, Kurdish and Cypriot greengrocers, fishmongers, butchers and bakeries on Green Lanes. Family-run, cash-heavy, thin-margin, fast-turning fresh stock, zero digital presence.

- **Perishable waste eats the margin.** Fresh produce and fish spoil fast, and grocery runs on razor-thin net margins of around 1 to 3% (CMA). Every binned tray is a total loss plus a disposal cost.
- **No way to summon demand.** When stock needs to move at 4pm, the trader can only hope someone walks past. No budget, no list, no broadcast.
- **Digitally invisible.** These shops are absent from every deals platform because they have no EPOS to integrate with. The exact thing that makes them unreachable for competitors makes them ready for a tool built for them.

The shopper's pain, the demand side

Two sub-segments, one app:

- **The squeezed household.** Needs to cut the food bill without cutting quality. Wants the saving, near home, on real food they will actually use, not a gamble.
- **The values-led deal-hunter.** Anti-waste, loves a bargain, already tracks reduction times. This is the early adopter and the word-of-mouth engine, and the future deal-spotter who fixes supply-side bandwidth.

> **The shared frustration both sides feel today**
>
> **The reduction is invisible the moment you are not physically standing in the shop.** All the value evaporates into thin air every single evening. Buntii makes it visible, searchable, and walkable.

4 · Why this works, the three fits

A startup lives or dies on three alignments: does the founder fit the market, does the product fit the market, and does the founder fit the product. Here is an honest scoring, strengths and fragile points both, because pretending the cracks are not there is how you fall through them.

Founder to Market fit: 9 out of 10

> The founder has worked a UK supermarket shop floor and run the markdown process first-hand. That is not a transferable skill you can hire. It is lived knowledge of how, when and why fresh stock gets reduced.

- **Shop-floor retail experience at a major UK supermarket** gives direct insider knowledge of markdown timing and reduction waves. The founder knows the rhythm of the thing being digitised.
- **A growth and GTM role at a B2B SaaS company** gives the go-to-market muscle to acquire two sides of a marketplace, not just build one.
- **Lives the problem.** Bargain-conscious, anti-waste, and culturally fluent in the independent-trader world the brand celebrates.

The one risk: trust dynamics inside a tight-knit trader community. An outsider asking shopkeepers to change their daily routine has to earn the room. Managed by going slow, in person, shop by shop.

Problem to Market fit: 8 out of 10 on problem, product unproven

- **Problem-fit is strong, 8 out of 10.** The waste is real, the cost-of-living demand is real, and the structural gap is real and verified. The problem is not in doubt.
- **Product-fit is unproven until real users validate it.** The open question is behavioural, not conceptual: will busy traders reliably post markdowns, and will shoppers reliably act on them? That is what the Green Lanes MVP exists to answer.

Founder to Product fit: 6 out of 10, the honest one

> This is the fragile fit, and naming it is the point of a bedrock document. Capturing reductions manually, every day, collides with a solo founder's bandwidth.

How we manage it, honestly: for the first phase, before funding, the founder does the manual work directly, walking the corridor and updating live reductions roughly every 30 minutes during peak markdown hours. It is hands-on and it does not scale forever, and we are clear-eyed about that. The structural fix is the strategy itself: the founder story builds an audience, the audience turns engaged shoppers into deal-spotters, and the spotters become the supply engine. Community fixes the bandwidth the founder alone cannot. The fragile fit is real today and gets stronger as the flywheel turns.

> **How the three fits chain together**
>
> **Founder story, builds audience, audience becomes deal-spotters, spotters fix supply bandwidth, operating in public turns validation into marketing.** Each fit feeds the next. That chain is the actual business model.

5 · The market, sized

The number	What it means for Buntii
Around £256bn UK grocery market (IGD 2025)	The pond. Forecast to around £297bn by 2030.
82.8% held by six chains (Kantar / USDA 2025)	The independent long tail is fragmented, underserved, and ours.
Around 270,000 tonnes a year retail food waste (WRAP)	The raw material. Around £1bn of supermarket loss alone.
Around £17bn edible food wasted in the UK a year (WRAP)	The ESG and cost-of-living tailwind behind the category.
Food prices up around 38% (Nov 2020 to Nov 2025)	Why deal-hunting went mainstream. Demand needs no education.
Fishmongers: around 10,000 in the 1950s to under 1,000 now	The independent high street needs exactly what we offer.

The honest caveat we keep in view: independent-sector data is genuinely thin. No public dataset counts independent greengrocer or fishmonger markdown behaviour by borough. That gap is the opportunity, but it means sizing the wedge precisely requires primary fieldwork on Green Lanes, not a spreadsheet. We are gathering that data ourselves from day one, which is also what becomes the long-term asset (see Section 6).

6 · The competition, and why we win

Gander has a year-plus head start, around £3 to £3.3m raised (per a 2025 FCA-approved EIS promotion), and integrations with Iceland, Morrisons Daily and Spar. We take that seriously. But its entire architecture, and the entire field's, leaves one segment untouched.

The field, and what each one cannot do

Player	Model	What it CANNOT do
Gander	Real-time, POS-integrated supermarket reductions	Reach any shop without an EPOS till
Too Good To Go	Mystery Surprise Bags, fixed pickup window	Let you choose the item, or go real-time
Olio	Free food-sharing plus B2B redistribution	Item-level priced independent markdowns
Karma	Choose-your-item, restaurant and café-led	Crack UK fresh grocery or independents
Approved Food etc.	Ambient clearance e-commerce, warehouse	Be local, fresh, real-time, or independent
Motatos	Warehouse surplus e-commerce	Survive in the UK; it exited in Sept 2023

The structural lock-out, the whole thesis

> ### You cannot integrate with a till that doesn't exist.
>
> Every real-time markdown competitor depends on POS or cloud-inventory integration. Independent greengrocers, fishmongers and market traders are the least-digitised segment in UK retail, and most have no EPOS at all. This is not a gap competitors close by trying harder. It is structural. The only ways to capture this data are lightweight trader self-input and crowdsourced community spotting, which is exactly Buntii's mechanism.

Three moats, ranked

1. **Off-POS independent-capture mechanism, the primary moat.** A trader self-input plus community-spotting system built for no-EPOS merchants. Hard to copy because it is an operational and community capability, not a software integration, and it is structurally off-limits to POS-dependent incumbents. Defensibility: high.
2. **Hyperlocal density, the compounding moat.** Winning a corridor street by street creates two-sided liquidity a diffuse national player cannot replicate locally. Defensibility: medium-high, location by location.
3. **The reduction-data asset, the long-term moat.** Structured, longitudinal data on what independents mark down, when, and by how much. A dataset that exists nowhere today. It becomes a B2B insight product and a barrier as it accumulates. Defensibility: grows over time.

The accelerate-trigger we watch

Gander's Bruce in a Box is the one tool that could in principle reach off-POS traders. As of 2026 there is no evidence it has launched at specialist independents. **If Gander runs a real campaign at independent fishmongers, greengrocers or market traders, that is our signal to accelerate spend and lock the segment first.**

7 · What our app does that no one else does

Three USP claims Buntii owns externally, each tied to a competitor it beats:

> **1. “Every reduction on the street, not just the supermarkets.”**
> Coverage of the independents nobody else lists. Beats Gander.

> **2. “See the actual item, not a mystery bag.”**
> Item-level, choose-what-you-want discovery. Beats Too Good To Go.

> **3. “Real-time, verified by your neighbours.”**
> Community verification attacks Gander's documented accuracy problem head-on. Beats Gander's trust gap.

How it actually works

Trader side: under 60 seconds, no hardware, no integration

- Onboarded in person. Posts a markdown by snapping a photo and price, or tapping a pre-loaded item tile such as “Tomatoes, half price, 20 left.”
- WhatsApp-based posting option, because traders already live in WhatsApp.
- Optional end-of-day clear-out broadcast to local followers. Zero fee at launch.

Shopper side: the live, walkable street

- A live map and feed of item-level reductions on the corridor, filterable by category (fish, veg, meat, bread).
- Spotted-by-the-community verification: shoppers confirm or flag items in-store, building the trust layer Gander lacks. Spotters earn status.
- Follow favourite traders and get pinged when they start reducing. Warm, witty, auntie-coded throughout.

> **Why this is defensible against a richer incumbent**
> Gander can outspend us on chain integrations, but it cannot integrate with tills that don't exist, and its accuracy depends on chain-staff compliance it can't control. **Our community and self-input model is the only viable mechanism for the independent segment, and density and data compound locally faster than a national player can seed. We do not fight Gander for POS chains. We own the independents Gander structurally can't reach.**

8 · The brand

IDENTITY

Buntii (cap B, double-i, lowercase rest). Never Bunty, Bunti, or Buntty. Domain **buntii.co.uk**, handle **@buntii.app**. The mark is a market-stall awning, the independent trader Gander can't reach, made visible.

Voice: the immigrant-mum register

Direct, declarative, scolding-with-love. Rhetorical questions as a weapon. Warm, frugal, anti-waste, a little bossy. Never an ad agency doing quirky. It should sound like the Turkish, Kurdish and Cypriot aunties who are literally the traders and shoppers.

> *“Auntie says: gone by 5pm. Move.”*
>
> *“Why pay £3 when it's 90p down the road?”*
>
> *“Fresh this morning. Don't be shy.”*
>
> *“For this price? Take two.”*
>
> *“Waste? Not in this house.”*

Tagline, locked: **Trust your auntie.** with the full stop included. The stop is the auntie.

The colour system: Split Surface

One rule runs everything: two surfaces, one brand. Pick the surface by context, and colour follows. White is the app, for product, listings and the map. Oat is the brand, for the landing page, deck, social and stickers.

Colour	Hex	Role
Olive	#6B7339	PRIMARY, identity, logo, UI, prices
Mustard	#D89A2E	ACCENT, deals and urgency only
Terracotta	#C5613B	SUPPORT, warmth only, never identity
Charcoal	#3D3528	Text on light
Oat	#FBF3E7	Brand surface
White	#FFFFFF	App surface

Two rules that never break: never place mustard directly touching olive, and terracotta is never the identity colour. That second rule is what stops Buntii reading as a generic reskin.

Type

Bricolage Grotesque (700/800) carries personality, for the wordmark, headlines and deal names. **DM Sans** (400/500/600) does the quiet work, for body, prices, buttons and captions. Both are free on Google Fonts. Never more than these two.